

Workshop summary

Strengthening Monitoring, Control and Surveillance (MCS) through an international instrument on high seas biodiversity

16 April 2019

Reid Hall, 4 Rue de Chevreuse, Paris



Background

Effective monitoring, control and surveillance (MCS) is critical for the success of marine conservation and management. Whereas States have the right to manage the marine resources within their national jurisdiction, the high seas are subject to a complex patchwork of international rules and regulations. As States begin to negotiate a new international agreement concerning areas beyond national jurisdiction (ABNJ), there is growing interest in how MCS tools and policies can be applied to this vast global commons.

The STRONG High Seas project (Strengthening Regional Ocean Governance for the High Seas) aims to strengthen regional ocean governance for the conservation and sustainable use of marine biodiversity in ABNJ, including through enhanced MCS tools and policies. This five-year project is working together with key science and policy actors in the Southeast Pacific and Southeast Atlantic regions to improve regional coordination and provide new lessons and approaches for high seas governance.

Workshop summary

On Wednesday 16 April 2019, partner institute [IDDR](#) organised the second STRONG High Seas expert workshop on monitoring, control and surveillance on “Strengthening Monitoring, Control and Surveillance (MCS) through an international instrument on high seas biodiversity” in Paris. This workshop built on the [MCS workshop on technological tools](#) held in July 2018.

The workshop covered four different themes: improving transparency at sea, lessons learnt from national experiences, lessons learnt from regional experiences and future policy options. During the workshop, all sixteen participants engaged in active discussions on possible approaches to strengthen MCS through a new international instrument on high seas biodiversity, currently under negotiation at the United Nations. This workshop provided an opportunity to take stock of existing legal and policy frameworks, highlight ongoing initiatives and technological developments, and develop options for the future treaty.

The key conclusions of both MCS expert workshops will be used in a report that will discuss the ways MCS might be able to play a role in the ongoing discussions on the new treaty. This report is due to be published in July 2019 so that it can feed into the next round of UN negotiations that will take place at the end of August this year.

Annex I: Agenda

9h30	Welcome - Glen Wright, IDDRI Presentation of IKI STRONG High Seas project - Ben Boteler, IASS Meeting objectives - Klaudija Cremers, IDDRI
10h	Session 1: Improving transparency at sea - Samantha Emmert, Global Fishing Watch - Discussant: Peter Horn, Pew
11h15	Coffee break
11h30	Session 2: Lessons learnt from national experiences - Claire Delepeuch & Barbara Hutniczak, OECD - Discussant: Klaudija Cremers, IDDRI
12h45	Lunch
14h	Session 3: Lessons learnt from regional experiences - Adriana Fabra, Tuna Compliance Network & International MCS Network - Hrannar Már Ásgeirsson, NEAFC - Discussant: Alejandro Anganuzzi, FAO
15h15	Coffee break
15h30	Session 4: Options for strengthening MCS through a high seas treaty - Duncan Currie, Globe Law - Discussant: Catherine Redgwell, Oxford University
17h30	Closure of the workshop

Annex II: Participants

Alejandro Anganuzzi, United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)

Ben Boteler, Institute for Advanced Sustainability Studies (IASS)

Klaudija Cremers, Institute for Sustainable Development and International Relations (IDDRI)

Duncan Currie, Globe Law

Claire Delepeuch, Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD)

Samantha Emmert, Global Fishing Watch

Adriana Fabra, Tuna Compliance Network & International MCS Network

Sylvie Giraud, Collecte Localisation Satellites (CLS)

Peter Horn, Pew Charitable Trusts

Barbara Hutniczak, Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD)

Julian Jackson, Pew Charitable Trusts

Charles Kilgour, Global Fishing Watch

Mathilde Kraft, Sciences Po

Hrannar Már Ásgeirsson, North-East Atlantic Fisheries Commission (NEAFC)

Catherine Redgwell, Oxford University

Mercedes Rosello, University of Hull

Gwilym Rowlands, Oxford University

Glen Wright, Institute for Sustainable Development and International Relations (IDDRI)

About the STRONG High Seas Project

The STRONG High Seas project is a five-year project that aims to strengthen regional ocean governance for the conservation and sustainable use of marine biodiversity in areas beyond national jurisdiction. It is coordinated by the Institute for Advanced Sustainability Studies (IASS) and implemented together with the Institute for Sustainable Development and International Relations (IDDRI), BirdLife International, the International Ocean Institute (IOI) – Southern Africa, the Universidad Católica del Norte (UCN), WWF Colombia, and WWF Germany. Working with the Secretariat of the Comisión Permanente del Pacífico Sur (CPPS; Permanent Commission for the South Pacific) and the Secretariat of the West and Central Africa Regional Seas Programme (Abidjan Convention), the project will develop and propose targeted measures to support the coordinated development of integrated and ecosystem-based management approaches for ocean governance in areas beyond national jurisdiction.

The STRONG High Seas project has the following overarching objectives:

1. Facilitate the development of improved management approaches for the conservation and sustainable use of biodiversity in areas beyond national jurisdiction in the Southeast Pacific and Southeast Atlantic regions;
2. Identify best practices and provide support to regional institutions and national authorities for implementing existing regional instruments;
3. Develop options for regional governance in a future international instrument under UNCLOS and transfer regional lessons learned to the global level to promote ocean governance.

For more information about the STRONG High Seas project, please visit: <https://www.prog-ocean.org/our-work/strong-high-seas/> or contact: stronghighseas@iass-potsdam.de.

Partners of the STRONG High Seas project



International Ocean Institute
African Region



Supported by:



Federal Ministry
for the Environment, Nature Conservation
and Nuclear Safety

based on a decision of the German Bundestag

The STRONG High Seas project is part of the International Climate Initiative (IKI; <http://www.international-climate-initiative.com/en/>). The Ministry for the Environment, Nature Conservation and Nuclear Safety (BMU) supports this initiative on the basis of a decision adopted by the German Bundestag.